

1. Understanding ChatGPT Work

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-30T23:59:47+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/30/understanding-chatgpt-work/>

OpenAI announced ChatGPT Work on July 9th, and have been furiously iterating on it ever since. It is an extraordinarily confusing and very powerful product. Here's what I've figured out about it so far. ChatGPT Work is actually two products. The more interesting version of ChatGPT Work is the one that runs in the cloud. This can be accessed via chatgpt.com or through the ChatGPT mobile apps. Let's call it Work Cloud. If you install the ChatGPT desktop app - the app that used to be called Codex - you gain access to a thing called ChatGPT Work that can access files and run programs directly on your computer. Let's call that one Work Local. This one feels more like regular Codex re-skinned to be less intimidating to non-software-developers. For the rest of this article I'm going to talk exclusively about Work Cloud. Work is for paid subscribers only. Right now, ChatGPT Work (in both flavors) is available only to \$20/month and up subscribers. Free users and \$8/month Go users do not have access. Work has features that aren't available in Chat. The interface for accessing Work is a tab selector, which presents it as an alternative to Chat. The obvious question is when should I use Chat,...

2. Before NTP there were Time and Daytime

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Sun, 30 Aug 2026 17:09:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/rfc-867-868-time/>

In building an NTP time demo on old Macs for VCF Midwest, I came across RFC 867 and RFC 868, for the 'Daytime' and 'Time' Protocols, respectively. My first exposure to any form of network time was when I upgraded from a used PowerBook 180c to my first 'new' computer, a Power Mac G3, in 2000. With the introduction of Mac OS 8.5, Apple added a 'Network Time Server' option in the Date & Time Control Panel.

3. Finalist 4

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-30T18:35:22Z

Link: https://www.finalist.works/?utm_source=df-aug-2026

My thanks to Finalist for sponsoring last week at Daring Fireball. Finalist is a remarkable, ambitious, and novel app for iPhone, iPad, and the Mac from indie developer Slaven Radic. It's a planner inspired by paper day planners. I wrote quite a bit about Finalist when it first sponsored DF back in December - you should read that post. I've been using Finalist ever since. It's a really good app. I'll just reiterate from the first post that what really resonates for me is the idea of adding tasks to days, not assigning dates to tasks. If you add some tasks and then never actually do them, they're still there, but they're in the past, not harassing you in an ever-growing list of undone stuff today. Finalist 4, which just came out a few weeks ago, is the biggest update yet. The headline new feature is notes, in the app or as a folder of Markdown files that round-trips with Obsidian. Tasks in those files land on the right day, next to your reminders and events, even inside the Mac menu bar app. Finalist's rebuilt Timeline lets you pencil tasks into your day, and Apple Pencil gets special powers to sketch the plan in seconds. There's tons more, brewed over four months with 1,000 bet...

4. How Americans See E.U. Tech?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T21:27:21Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gGlpBuW6ZFc>

I think at least half a dozen people have sent me a link to this video and now that I've watched it, I understand why. Perfect. ?

5. We Certainly Have Made a Hames Out of This

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T19:42:59Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/linked/2026/08/28/trump-lake-ontario>

I mentioned earlier that for anyone going along with the ruse that Lake Ontario is now named Lake America, the HOMES mnemonic no longer holds, the only two valid words in English with the new five letters are hames and shame, and that hames is rather too obscure. But it's not so obscure in Ireland, where they use it in an idiom: to make a hames of something is to make a mess of it. With that in mind, it's hard to say which is more apt for this embarrassment, hames or shame. (The other longstanding Great Lakes mnemonic is the phrase "Super Man Helps Every One", which I don't love because neither Superman nor everyone ought to be treated as two words, but it does have the advantage of sorting the lakes geographically from west to east.) ?

6. New Pebble Weather App + Software Updates

Source: Eric Migicovsky's Blog RSS Feed | Published: Sun, 30 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://repebble.com/blog/new-pebble-weather-app-software-updates>

All Pebble Time 2 invites have been sent and we're now in-stock! It's been a long Time coming, but if you have been waiting, now is your?

7. Cores in space: The core memory module from a 1980 Spacelab computer

Source: Ken Shirriff's blog | Published: 2026-08-30T09:42:42.929-07:00

Link: <http://www.righto.com/2026/08/spacelab-core-memory.html>

Spacelab was a reusable laboratory that could be carried in the Space Shuttle's cargo bay, providing lab space for astronauts and experiments. 1 Because Spacelab was a European project, it used a French-built minicomputer, the Mitra 125 MS, 2 rather than the Shuttle's main computers, IBM-built AP-101 systems. For storage, the Spacelab computer contained 128 kilobytes of RAM. Rather than silicon memory, the computer used magnetic core memory, with each bit stored in a tiny ferrite ring. In this article, I take a close look at this computer's core memory system. The core stack from the Spacelab computer. I removed the top board to show the core planes. The illustration below shows how Spacelab fit inside the Shuttle's cargo bay. The pressurized laboratory is the cylindrical module in the front of the cargo bay, connected to the Shuttle by a tunnel. Experiments were mounted on pallets behind the laboratory. The laboratory held three identical Mitra computers. 3 One computer managed Spacelab itself, while the second computer managed the experiments. The third computer provided a backup in case of failures. Spacelab was a pressurized cylinder in the Shuttle's cargo bay, connected to th...

8. Recreating a 2010 Experiment

Source: Matt Godbolt's blog | Published: 2026-08-30T19:40:00Z

Link: http://xania.org/202608/recreating-a-2010-experiment?utm_source=feed&utm_medium=rss

Hooking a BBC Master up as a serial terminal to browse the web again

9. ActivityBot is the recipient of an NLnet grant!

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 30 Aug 2026 11:34:55 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/activitybot-is-the-recipient-of-an-nlnet-grant/>

Back in February, I applied for NLnet's Next Generation Zero grant. They were looking for Fediverse projects to help rewild the social media landscape. Or, as they describe it: Reclaim the public nature of the internet Small and medium-sized R&D grants between 5.000 and 50.000 euro, with the possibility to scale up. I run ActivityBot - it is a single-file ActivityPub server suitable for?

10. On Inevitability

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +1000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/on-inevitability>

Why superintelligent AI is not inevitable.

11. My Experience Has Nuance, Yours Is a Data Point

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Mon, 31 Aug 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/nuance-for-me-none-for-you/>

Eric Bailey has a fun little post about how we need more than a few icons to express the nuance

of our shared human experience. For example, he suggests Netflix provide some feedback buttons to indicate the kinds of experiences we all share consuming and rating media: "Just because I expressed interest in this show does not mean I want to be inundated with recommendations for its genre?" "Disregard [that I pressed "thumbs up"] my cat walked over the keyboard?" "I am making bad choices and hatewatching this?" (which reminds me of) What's great about the examples in Eric's post is how familiar they are. We can read them and laugh because we've had the same thought ? "I'm pressing "thumbs up" here, but what I really mean is?" We know when we click that button that it's a reductive expression of our experience that'll be erroneously interpreted, but we do it anyway. As Bryan Cantrill shared from his experience: There's no way to indicate, "I'm engaging with this, but I hate myself for doing it." I need another mouse button that is like, "I'm clicking on this, but I'm rage clicking on it and for my own mental health could you not drag more of this in front of me please?" We know these fe...

12. Forgejo hack #2: Integration with Read The Docs

Source: Miguel Grinberg's Blog | Published: Sun, 30 Aug 2026 16:02:08 GMT

Link: <https://blog.miguelgrinberg.com/post/forgejo-hack-2-integration-with-read-the-docs>

In this second Forgejo Hack installment I'll tell you how to connect a git repository that lives in your self-hosted Forgejo instance to Read the Docs , so that commits to the repository automatically trigger documentation builds, exactly like it works with GitHub.